Hanna Sistek

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Academic Appointments

2026-2027 | **Postdoctoral Civil Discourse Fellow**
Edmond & Lily Safra Center for Ethics
Harvard University, Cambridge, MA

2026- | **Research Affiliate**
Governance and Responsible AI Lab (GRAIL)
Student Perspectives on AI Research & Knowledge Lab (SPARK), John Martinson Honors College
Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN

2025-2026 | **Postdoctoral Fellow**
Center for American Political History, Media, and Technology (CAPT) & Governance and Responsible AI Lab (GRAIL)
Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN

Education

2025 | **Ph.D. Political Science**
Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN
Major field: Comparative Politics
Minor fields: International Relations, Political Methodology
Dissertation: Structural Incentives for Politicians to Manipulate Domestic Opinion
Committee Members: Cherie D. Maestas (chair), Andy Baker, Mollie Cohen, Marcus Mann

2021 | **M.A. Political Science**
Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN

2005 | **Journalism degree**
University of Gothenburg, Sweden

2003 | **B.S. Physical Therapy**
Lund University, Sweden
Exchange year, University of Melbourne, Australia (2002)

Peer-Reviewed Publications

** indicates a graduate student co-author, ‡ indicates a recent graduate (early-career) co-author.*

1. Hannah, Matthew, Jennifer Hoewe, **Hanna Sistek**, Taeik Kim*, and Dan Goldwasser. 2024. **"A mindfulness-based information literacy framework for the current information environment."** *Journal of Information Literacy, 18*(2).
[Named a Top 20 Article of 2024 by the Library Instruction Round Table of the American Library Association]

Working Papers

1. "Escalating Political Use of Disinformation: A New Reputational Theory Explaining Communication Changes in Democracies" *Revise & Resubmit*.
2. "Asymmetric Behavioral Shifts in Political Use of Disinformation: Case Study Interview Evidence From Europe"
3. "Asymmetric Accountability: Affective Polarization and Public Responses to Political Disinformation"
4. "Public Justifications of Political Disinformation in the United States: Comparing Manual Coding and Generative AI Classification" with Normand Péladeau and Priyadevi McNamara‡.

Works in Progress

1. "Using Large Language Models to practice cross-partisan dialogue" with Daniel Schiff (pre-analysis plan available upon request).
2. "AI as a Tool Against Partisan Disinformation"
3. "The Effect of Disinformation on Twittersphere Sentiment – Not Much When Debunked"

Research Software & Digital Projects

† indicates an undergraduate student team member

1. *ConvoLab*: Human-AI interaction application designed to let users practice having difficult political conversations with people they disagree with, using two AI agents.
Repository: https://github.com/GRAIL-center/ConvoLab. Current team: Nebras Alam†, Brinda Akuthota†, Andrew Le Blanc†, Anuj Nair†, Jaskeerat Singh Khosla† and Rohan Sunchu†.

Public Engagement

1. **CAPTivated** Podcast, Center for American Political History, Media, and Technology, Purdue University. Released February 5, 2026; new episodes biweekly. Participated in the first season. *Co-founder, Co-host, and Co-producer*.

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

External

2026 | Best Dissertation Award. APSA Information Technology and Politics Section.

2026 | Honorable Mention, Thomas E. Patterson Best Dissertation Award. APSA Political Communication Section.

2026 | Travel Award to attend APSA. Rapoport Family Foundation.*$1,500*

2024 | Rapoport Doctoral Dissertation Grant. *$15,000*

2024 | SPARK Award. APSA Political Communication Section. *$750*

2024 | Peter Mair Travel Award. APSA European Politics and Society Section. *$300*

2024 | Prestage-Cook Award. Southern Political Science Association. *$300*

2016 | Innovation in Development Reporting Grant, European Journalism Centre.
Project: The Price of Basmati. *€18,510*

2012 | Language Studies Grant (Arabic, in Cairo), Swedish Journalist Union. *$1,800*

2008 | Innovation Journalism Fellow, H-STAR Institute, Stanford University (Vinnova)

Selected Internal

2022-2025 | Purdue University: Postdoctoral Supplemental Travel Award; Graduate Peer Reviewed Article Award; Graduate Grant Submission Award (multiple years); Promise Travel Grant; Institute for Information Literacy. *Total: $2,500*

2024, 2020 | Summer Research Grants (Purdue Graduate School, Purdue Research Foundation)
Total: $10,400

2024 | Outstanding Teaching Assistant. Departmental award.

2023 | Teaching Assistant of the Year. Award by Pi Sigma Alpha, Purdue University

Invited Talks

May 2026 | "ConvoLab - building an AI dialogue coaching app".
Applied Social Media Lab Forum at the Berkman Klein Center for Internet & Society, Harvard University

February 2026	"Using AI as a Research Assistant". Guest Lecture for COMM 140: Fundamentals of Media Communication, College of Liberal Arts and Sciences at University of Illinois Chicago
February 2026	"Using AI to ask Historical Questions". Workshop with Aaron Mendon-Plasek for the History Department, Purdue University
October 2025	"Navigating Political Violence News in the Digital Age". Center for C-SPAN Scholarship & Engagement (CCSE), Purdue University
October 2025	“Behind the Headlines”. Joint seminar presentation with Sage Goodwin. Center for American Political History, Media, and Technology, Purdue University

Conference Presentations

RAD	2026 (poster) Rochester Area Democracy Conference, University of Rochester
SPSA	2026, 2025
PolComm	2026, 2025 APSA Political Communication Preconference
APSA	2026, 2025, 2024, 2023
RMCEPS	2025 (poster) Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science, New York University
ISA	2025
MPSA	2026, 2025, 2024, 2023, 2022
WPSA	2023
ICTS	2023 International Conspiracy Theory Symposium, University of Miami

Teaching and Research Experience

Instructor of Record

Summer 22/23	**POL 130 - Introduction to International Relations**

Research Assistant

AY 2018/19	**Editorial Assistant for *Politics, Groups, and Identities*.**

Teaching Assistant: Graduate level

Fa 24/Sp 25	**SCLA 521 - Societal Impacts of AI**
Fa 24/Sp 25	**SCLA 522 - Artificial Intelligence Policy, Governance, and Ethics**

Teaching Assistant: Undergraduate level

Fa 23, Sp 24	**POL 223 - Introduction to Environmental Policy and Politics**
Fa 22, Sp 22, Sp 23	**POL 327 - Global Green Politics**
Fall 2022	**POL 323 - Comparative Environmental Policy and Politics**
Fall 2021	**POL 141 - Introduction to Comparative Politics**
Fall 2021	**POL 323 - Renewable Energy Politics Around the World**
Spring 2021	**SCLA 102 - Cornerstone class on Transformative texts, Critical Thinking & Oral Communication II: Modern World "Democracy, Citizenship and Civic Duty"**
Fall 2021	**SCLA 102 - Cornerstone class on Transformative texts, Critical Thinking and Oral Communication II: "Technology, Great Power, and Its Responsibilities"**
Spring 2020	**POL 237 - Introduction to U.S. Foreign Policy**
Fall 2019	**POL 130 - Introduction to International Relations**

Selected Additional Training

May, 2026	**Summer Institute in Computational Social Sciences** *University of Rochester, NY*
April, 2026	**Text Analytics in the Generative AI Era 2.0** *Normand Péladeau/Provalis Research, Chicago*
January, 2026	**AI-Assisted Qualitative Research** *Trena Paulus/KiND Institute, New Orleans*
January, 2026	**Experiments in the Social Sciences** *Donald Green/KiND Institute, New Orleans*
September, 2025	**Temporal ERGM for Network Panel Data** *Scott Duxbury, UNC/The Methodology Center at Purdue*
April, 2025	**Generative AI for Survey Research: Principles and Applications** *The New York Chapter of the American Association for Public Opinion Research Webinar*
April, 2025	**Writing Policy Briefs and Op-Eds Communicating Research with Policymakers and Community** *International Studies Association Webinar*
April, 2025	**Demystifying the Automated Analysis of Open-Ended Survey Responses** *American Association for Public Opinion Research Webinar*
February, 2025	**Supervision in Machine Learning** *Workshop, Graduate Professional Development, Purdue University*
January, 2025	**Foundations in Machine Learning** *KiND Institute/SPSA workshop, Puerto Rico*

January, 2025 | **Data Coding in Qualitative Research**
KiND Institute/SPSA workshop, Puerto Rico

November, 2024 | **The AI Imperative: Purdue-Google AI Summit**
Hyatt Regency, Indianapolis

Fall 2023 | **Qualitative In-depth Interview Method: A Quality Approach to Data Collection and Analysis Setup**
American Association for Public Opinion Research Short Course

Fall 2023 | **Interpretive Process Tracing & Practice Tracing**
APSA Short Course

Pedagogical Training

Summer 2022 | **Certificate in Foundations of College Teaching**
Foundations of College Teaching Purdue University

Languages and Skills

Languages: Swedish and Czech (native); English (fluent); German (intermediate); French and Arabic (basic)

Software: R, Python, Git, LaTeX, Qualtrics, NVivo, Docker

Learning Management Systems: Blackboard, Brightspace

Service

Department

AY 2023/24 Spring 2025 | **Political Science Research Collaboratory**
Mentored undergraduate research assistants on comparative research about media systems, academic writing and survey research. Purdue University

Committees

2025-2026 | **Co-Organizer of first Annual "Summit on Information, Technology and American Democracy"**
Public summit in Indianapolis on April 30th, 2026, organized by CAPT/GRAIL. Gathered thought leaders, educators, policymakers and scholars to discuss the impact of AI and algorithms on our media ecosystem. The event featured an interactive theater performance, moderated panels, community partners and public discussions.

2025-2026 | **Member, Information Intelligence Working Group**
Interdisciplinary development of an "information intelligence" program for youth and civic organizations.

Discipline

2026 | **MPSA**
Discussant

2025 | **Polarization Consortium Workshop**
Discussant

2025 | **APSA**
Chair

2025 | **SPSA**
Discussant and Chair

2024 | **National Institute of Standards and Technology AI Safety Institute Consortium**
Member of Working Group on Synthetic Content

2023 | **APSA, MPSA, WPSA**
Discussant

Relevant Non-academic work experience

Reporter & Staff Writer

2004-2018 | **Freelance**
Based in India, Egypt and Silicon Valley. Reporting from 19 countries for over 100 outlets.

Summer 2017 | **Etc Göteborg**
Gothenburg, Sweden

Summer 2016 | **KIT**
Stockholm, Sweden

Spring 2008 | **CNET News**
San Francisco, U.S.

Summer 2007 | **Dagens Industri**
Stockholm, Sweden

Summer 2006 | **Göteborgs-Posten**
Gothenburg, Sweden

Spring 2006 | **Veckans Affärer**
Stockholm, Sweden

Memberships

American Political Science Association, Midwest Political Science Association, Southern Political Science Association

References

Cherie D. Maestas
Associate Dean of Research, Innovation, and Graduate Education, College of Liberal Arts, Professor of Political Science, Purdue University.
cmaestas@purdue.edu.
Dissertation Chair.

Kathryn Cramer Brownell
Professor in History, and Director of Center for American Political History, Media, and Technology, Purdue University.
brownell@purdue.edu.
Postdoctoral Supervisor.

Daniel Schiff
Associate Professor in Political Science and Co-director of Governance and Responsible AI Lab, Purdue University.
dschiff@purdue.edu.
Postdoctoral Advisor.